

Passage 1 (中秋家庭传统)

Mid-Autumn Festival is one of the most important Chinese festivals. For my family, it is a time for family members to get (get) together. This tradition is kept (keep) in our family for many years. It is a time for sb to do sth to get 传统被保持 has been kept

On that day, my grandma will make mooncakes by hand. They taste much better than those

3 bought (buy) from shops. After dinner, we sit in the yard and enjoy the bright full moon. My

grandma often tells old stories about Chang'e while we eat mooncakes. It is 4 a warm moment for all of us.

We also write short wishes on paper and hang them on our tree in the yard. We hope our family will stay healthy and happy. These small activities make our family much 5 closer (close). I think family traditions connect people 6 with each other. They remind us 7 to love our family.

Sometimes my cousins cannot come home because 8 their busy work remind sb. to do sth. We will have a video call together then. No matter how far we are, the tradition stays with us. I hope we 9 will carry (carry) on this nice tradition in the future. It is 10 a treasure for our whole family.

Passage 2 (国外家庭周日晚餐传统)

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Passage 2 (国外家庭周日晚餐传统)

In many Western families, Sunday dinner is an old family tradition. Every Sunday evening, the whole family sits down to enjoy a big meal together. This tradition ¹ was started (start) by my great-grandma over 80 years ago.

Before dinner, everyone helps prepare food. The kids help set the table while parents cook. During dinner, we talk about our week. We share happy moments and also talk about problems ² what we meet at school or work. No one uses mobile phones at the table, ³ so we can listen to each other carefully.

This simple tradition makes our family stronger. It teaches us ⁴ to respect (respect) each other. Sometimes relatives come to join us. We laugh and enjoy delicious food together. We believe family time is ⁵ more important (important) than anything else.

Last month we moved to a new city. At first we worried ⁶ about (if) we could keep the tradition. But we still make it every Sunday. I hope that when I have my own family one day, I ⁷ will continue (continue) this lovely tradition. Traditions help us remember ⁸ our (we) roots. They are ⁹ truly (true) the best gift ¹⁰ for (for) our family.

Passage 2 (海伦凯勒, 励志伟人)

Helen Keller was a well-known writer and speaker. When she was only 19 months old, a serious illness made her lose both sight 1 and hearing. At first, she could not communicate with others and felt angry and lonely. Luckily, her teacher Anne Sullivan came to help her when Helen 2 was (be) seven.

Anne taught Helen to understand words by touching. With great patience, Helen learned 3 to read (read) and write. Later she went to college and got a degree. She spent most of her life 4 fighting (fight) for the rights of disabled people. She wrote many books, among 5 which The Story of My Life is the most popular.

Helen believed that nothing was impossible for those 6 who kept trying. She often gave speeches to tell people to value what they had. Her story tells us that we should not give up when facing trouble. Even 7 though we meet hard times, we can find ways out. Her strong will has touched 8 thousands (thousand) of people. We are all moved by 9 her (she) courage. She is truly 10 a hero.

III. 语法填空 (共 10 分)

Many years ago, there were many states (国家) in China. The State of Qi used to be very strong, but it became less powerful. Yan Zi was a wise man who gave suggestions (suggest) to the king, so the king of Qi sent him to ask Chu to cooperate.

The king of Chu knew Yan Zi was very short. He tried to make Yan Zi feel (feel) shy about his height. When Yan Zi arrived, the guard told him to enter through the small gate. Yan Zi didn't get mad at him. "Only a state of dogs will greet visitors with a gate for dogs. I'm visiting the State of Chu. This gate isn't for me," Yan Zi said. So the guard had to take him through the main gate.

The king of Chu was unhappy at what Yan Zi did. "Why did Qi send YOU? Don't they have anyone better?" the king tried another way.

"If Qi meets a great king, it sent (send) the best ambassador (使臣). I'm the worst (bad). That's why I'm here," Yan Zi replied calmly (镇定地). At this time, a thief was brought (bring) by the guards to the king. The thief was from Qi. "Ha! Yan Zi, is Qi a state of thieves?" asked the king impolitely (impolite). Yan Zi replied, "The orange trees south of Huai River produce big and delicious fruit, but the orange trees north of Huai River produce small and sour fruit. while The environment makes the fruit grow differently. In Qi, people are good and honest, but here, they steal. What made their (they) qualities change here?" Finally, the king looked at Yan Zi and laughed, "I was wrong about you and your state!"

The story of Yan Zi shows that we should make an effort to win others' respect with our own courage and wisdom.

Passage 2 (苏格拉底, 西方思辨思想)

Socrates was a great ancient Greek thinker. He had a special way of teaching, now called the Socratic method. ^{prep.} Instead of 1 telling (tell) students answers directly, he asked questions to make them think for 2 themselves (they).

At that time, many people thought they knew everything. But Socrates kept asking questions and

showed them that they might not understand things well. He believed that 3 a wise person knows that he knows little. His ideas were new and many local leaders did not agree 4 with him.

Later, he was put to death, 5 but his students kept his ideas alive. Socrates told people that they should question everything and look for the truth. He advised people 6 to care (care) about their inner world more than money or fame. His great ideas 7 have changed (have changed) Western thinking ever since.

Now many teachers still use his method in class. It helps students develop 8 their (they) critical thinking. We can learn from Socrates: never stop questioning and keep searching 9 in for truth. His spirit is 10 really (real) valuable to us.

Unit 3 Family traditions

Unit 4 A better me

Passage 1 (改掉拖延习惯, 自我提升)

Last year I had a big problem: I always put things off till the last minute. This bad habit made me feel worried and stressed. I decided 1 to make (make) a change and become a better me.

At first, I made small daily plans. Instead of waiting until night to finish homework, I started doing tasks right after school. I also stopped 2 to playing (play) phone games before finishing my work. When I felt tired, I took short breaks instead of giving up. Little by little, I found 3 easier to finish my work on time.

Sometimes I still wanted to delay tasks. But I told 4 me myself (I) that progress matters more than perfect results. My teacher told me that small changes could lead 5 to lead to big differences. After several months, I became much 6 more responsible (responsible). I no longer stay up late for schoolwork.

Now I know improving myself is 7 a long journey. We cannot change everything in one day. As long 8 as we keep trying, we can make progress. I will keep working hard 9 to be (be) a 10 best better (good) version of (me).

Passage 2 (坚持运动+阅读, 塑造更好的自己)

I used to be shy and weak. I seldom exercised and spent lots of time staying indoors. I wanted to

long 8 as we keep trying, we can make progress. I will keep working hard ⑨ to be (be) a 10 best ^{better} (good) version of (me). ^{更好}

Passage 2 (坚持运动+阅读, 塑造更好的自己)

I used to be shy and weak. I seldom exercised and spent lots of time staying indoors. I wanted to become healthier and more confident, so I made a plan 1 to improve myself.

I decided to run for 20 minutes every morning. At the beginning, I felt tired easily and wanted to stop. But I encouraged 2 myself (I) to keep going. I also started reading books for half an hour every night. Reading helped me open my eyes and learn new ideas. It made me 3 smarter (smart) than before.

Six months later, great changes took place. I became stronger and braver. I was no longer afraid 4 of speaking in front of the whole class. My parents said they were 5 proud of me.

I learn that becoming a better person is not easy. It needs patience and strong will. We may meet difficulties along the way, 6 but we should never give up. Every small effort ⑦ counts (count).

If you want to change, start now. Don't wait till tomorrow. We can always make 8 ourselves (we) better as long as we keep working. This experience teaches me 9 valuable ^{to do} (value) the process more than the result. It is a wonderful journey of 10 self-improvement ^{to value} (自我提高).